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Purpose/Policy:

“This “Can Line Can Coder” standard operating procedure has been created to assist operators with setup, operations, changeover, cleaning, and troubleshooting.

Scope:

The “Can Coder” is required for date coding the bottom of cans. The date coder system will also allow you to change the date code formatting.

The purpose of the “Can Coder” is to add the proper “pkg” date code on the bottom of the can via our “Date Code Matrix”.

Definitions/Acronyms:

- SOP – Standard Operating Procedure
- PPE – Personal Protective Equipment
- HMI – Human Machine Interface (the touch screen used to control a machine)
- LED – Light Emitting Diode (indicator light)
- Can Coder – Printer that puts the package date code on the bottom of cans
- Warmer – Steam tunnel that warms filled cans to help mitigate condensation

Authorities/Responsibilities:

“This SOP can be completed by an entry level packaging operator after proper training from a senior member of the Can line packaging team. The objective of this SOP is to gain the knowledge needed to operate the “Can Line Can Coder” and trouble shoot any issues that may arise.”

Resources and Materials:

Operations:

- Not Applicable

Changeovers:

- Date Coder is mounted on a heigh setting stand.

Basic Cleaning:

- Makeup Fluid (Type A).
- Lacquer thinner.
- Dry Rag/Paper Towel

Deep Clean:

- Refer to SOP Document: Can line Zone 4 Cleaning

- N:\Operations\Production\Boston\Packaging\Canning Line\Canning 2025\Zone Cleaning 2025\Can Line Upper Level\Zone 4 - Warmer Area

Troubleshooting:

- No Equipment required.

PPE Required:

Include formal PPE required. Include suggested PPE is no formal is required.

- No formal PPE required suggested nitrate gloves for cleaning.

Procedures:

Setting up the Can Line Can Coder:

1. Inspect the cover and internals for Ink/debris/makeup fluid; clean if necessary.
2. Attach the cover carefully, as there is a small magnet inside the metal cover that can break easily.
3. Press the power switch on the right side of the coder.
   3.1 *NOTE:* If the can coder is already on, please disregard step #3.
4. Select Start (green button at the top right of touch screen).
5. Confirm OK, the machine will begin warming the ink and will take a few minutes to cycle on.
6. Check that the correct date code is set for the run.
   6.1 Please refer to the “Date Code SOP” for more information.

Changing Date Code Formatting:

1. From the home menu on the HMI screen, select “select message” from the bottom menu.
2. Select the desired format.
   2.1 *NOTE*: The format screen has pre-loaded messages we use for different products. These formats may require edits depending on the “Date Code SOP” requirements.
3. Confirm Selection

Editing the Date Coder Message:

1. From the home menu on the HMI screen, select “edit message” from the bottom menu.
2. Select “show cursor” on the top right menu of the edit message screen if it is not already displaying.
3. Use the on-screen keyboard to make the desired changes.
4. Press “apply” on the top right menu of the edit message screen.

Advanced Editing of the Date Coder Message:

Add Julian date to a date code.

1. Select “edit message”.
2. Select “show cursor” if it is not already displaying and move cursor to the row and column to be edited.
3. Select “Calendar/Count”
4. Press “Total Days” three times.
5. Three capitals (T’s) should appear in the selected area with a grey highlighted TTT.
6. Press Apply.
7. Verify that the date is correct. If not, you may need to look in the operations or environmental settings to calibrate the calendar.

Shutting Down the Can Coder:

1. Select “Shut Down” (red button at the top right of touch screen main menu).
2. Confirm OK, the machine will take a few minutes to cycle off.
3. Once complete, press the power switch.

Basic Cleaning of the Can Coder:

1. Once the machine has powered down, remove the print head from the “Can Coder” by loosening the bolt that holds the cover on.
    1.1 *Note:* The coder must be off for cleaning! Otherwise, it will get in the ink return tube (the gutter) and ruin the ink in the reservoir.
2. Clean the print head with the appropriate make-up fluid.
    2.1 Point the printer head in the downward position, so it may drain away from the electronics.
    2.2 A good rule of thumb is to avoid spraying behind the red LED.

Deep Cleaning of the Can Coder

1. Refer to SOP Document: Can line Zone 4 Cleaning
    1.1 N:\Operations\Production\Boston\Packaging\Canning Line\Canning 2025\Zone Cleaning 2025\Can Line Upper Level\Zone 4 - Warmer Area

Forms:

Not Applicable

Reference Documents:

Not Applicable

Common Issues:

Adjusting message placement

1. To adjust vertical placement, loosen print head mount and shift position accordingly.
   1.1 After making a change, run a test to check placement.
   1.2 You will need to turn the air rinser on to bring cans through the date coder.
   1.3 Verify the placement is correct.
2. To adjust the horizontal positioning, move the print head back and forth to where the sensor is reading the bottom bevel of the can.
   2.1 *NOTE: The sensor measures the distance between each can and determines the print spacing.*
   2.2 After making a change, run a test to check placement.
   2.3 You will need to turn the air rinser on to bring cans through the date coder.
   2.4 Verify the placement is correct.
3. To make advanced adjustments to the horizontal positioning, press “print spec” on the bottom menu of the main screen.
   3.1 After making a change, run a test to check placement.
   3.2 You will need to turn the air rinser on to bring cans through the date coder.
   3.3 Verify the placement is correct.
4. Adjust the “print start delay” accordingly to shift the placement of the message and press “apply”.
   4.1 After making a change, run a test to check placement.
   4.2 You will need to turn the air rinser on to bring cans through the date coder.
   4.3 Verify the placement is correct.

Document History and Approval:

Revise document history as described in the table and key below.

(Reference to following document: B1C.SOP.P001: Document Control and Approval Procedure Template)

VERSION NO.	VERSION DATE	DESCRIPTION OF CHANGE	AUTHOR NAME/PROJECT MANAGER
001	2024/03/12		Kyle Szymanski
002	2026/10/26	Updated SOP to Newest Layout Version	Kyle Szymanski

Version Approval Number: 002

Approved by: Kyle Szymanski

Position Title: OSCI Manager

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